

Historical overachievers such as political and military masterminds such as Winston Churchill and Napoleon Bonaparte as well as prolific inventors such as Nikola Tesla, Thomas Edison, and Leonardo Da Vinci have been known to practice polyphasic sleep. That pretty much explains how these individuals managed to get so much done in their time. However, the long term effects of reduced sleep are yet unknown, so try this at your own risk. Having said that, polyphasic sleep makes perfect sense during crunch times when increasing productivity is a do or die affair.

DE-STRESSING THROUGH TECHNOLOGY

Now that we have figured out how to rest, it's time to notch that a few steps further in a more relevant manner – through gadgets and technology. But before we get to that, it must be noted that so far we have conclusively learned that genius-level military tacticians and prolific inventors evidently know how to work their brains long and hard without fatigue. Therefore, it makes perfect sense to take cues from their present-day counterparts. Although the absence of wars in the modern world rules out the former category of geniuses, thankfully inventors aren't in short supply.

Meet Dr Yoshiro Nakamatsu. Widely known as the Edison of Japan, this prolific modern-day inventor is credited with inventing the floppy disk, CD, DVD, and over 3000 other patents to his credit. Like his historical counterparts, the eccentric genius doesn't sleep as long as regular people. He augments his four-hour core sleep with twenty minute power naps. He takes these power naps on a specially designed chair dubbed Cerebrex.

The chair is yet another one of his inventions that is a cut above the rest. Nakamatsu claims that the Cerebrex employs technology to improve mental acuity by boosting memory and math capability in addition to stimulating creativity. The chair achieves this by subjecting the body to sonic frequencies to stimulate blood circulation and make the brain perform better. The Japanese inventor claims that just twenty minutes of rest in his chair has the same effect as eight hours of sleep.

Fortunately, you don't necessarily have to make a beeline for Japan to get your

own brain rejuvenating chair. If you don't mind spending upwards of ₹80,000 on a chair, you can choose between recliners with built in massage function and full-blown massage chairs. They lack the fancy sonic massage feature of Dr Nakamatsu's Cerebrex, but an increasing number of corporate executives employed in high stress jobs are lapping up these comfortable recliners. This isn't just needless extravagance. It's a great investment that could go a long way towards reducing stress and increasing productivity.

FUELLING CREATIVITY WITH OXYGEN

If you thought sonic chairs for stimulating the brain treads the territory of weird and eccentric, you ought to hear what Dr Nakamatsu does for creative inspiration. The inventor has a penchant for coming



Listening to your favourite tunes can, for a short time, boost your brain power, even (*ugh*) for Beliebers!

up with his best ideas under water. He does that by diving underwater without any artificial breathing apparatus and just a specially designed plexiglass tablet to jot down his ideas. The logic behind this exercise is the inventor's theory that oxygen deprivation is a great catalyst for creativity and that the best ideas conjured when you're at the verge of drowning.

"You must dive deep and allow the water pressure to deprive the brain of blood," explains the 86 year old inventor. "Zero point five seconds before death, I visualize an invention." This may seem an awful lot like the weird and potentially fatal fetish of autoerotic asphyxiation that claimed David Carradine of Kill Bill fame,

but there's a method to this apparent madness. Dr Nakamatsu believes that the sudden rush of oxygen to the brain reinvigorates it, which in turn helps with creativity and inspiration for killer ideas.

Yet again, there's a much better and more importantly safer way to do the same thing. Just visit a bar. Not just any kind of bar – mind you – but an oxygen bar. Yes, these bars serve oxygen and they were introduced in Indian metros as far back as 1998. Like all things eccentric, this concept too emerged out of Japan in the early '90s. These bars were set up as a means for health conscious individuals to combat oxygen deprivation caused by increasing pollution in cities. An hour long session in an average oxygen bar costs between ₹300 to 1000 depending on whether the gas is delivered through a cylinder or inside a specially designed chamber.

Regular sessions are touted to deliver a host of benefits ranging from anti-ageing, boosting immunity, and improving sleep cycle to curing various medical ailments. However, there's no medical proof to back up any of those claims. This concept is nevertheless derived from hyperbaric oxygen chambers used by the military, diving industry, and even in hospitals to treat burn victims. Supplying injured patients with 100 percent oxygen at high atmospheric pressures has been found to rapidly accelerate the body's healing process. The veracity of the medical benefits notwithstanding, breathing scented oxygen at one of these places should be refreshing enough to kickstart your brain.

ALL WORK AND NO PLAY

In a distinct departure from bizarre means suggested thus far to refresh the brain, videogames definitely rank as the most popular and fun way to de-stress after a long day. This widely practiced hobby is generally associated with all the negativity in the world thanks to an attitude borne out of the belief that if something is enjoyable then it must be bad. For example, the most common refrain of concerned parents about videogames is that it makes their kids go blind and dumbs them down.

Research has found that playing twitchy FPS games actually improves vision and the ability of the brain of process visual information. Far from dumbing gamers down, videogames